

10. USER VERIFICATION & TRUST

10.1 SHIPPER VERIFICATION

Individual Shippers

Basic Verification (Required):

Step 1: Phone Number

- Enter mobile number
- SMS verification code sent
- Enter code to verify
- Prevents duplicate accounts
- Primary contact method

Step 2: Identity

- Upload National ID (both sides)
- Or Passport (photo page)
- AI validates document:
 - Checks document authenticity
 - Extracts name, ID number, DOB
 - Matches with user input
- Manual review for flagged cases
- Approval within 24 hours

Step 3: Address

- Proof of residence (optional but recommended)
- Utility bill (within 3 months)
- Bank statement
- Rental agreement
- Improves trust score

Enhanced Verification (Optional - Higher Trust):

Bank Account Verification:

- Link bank account or mobile money

- **Small deposit verification**
- **Confirms financial standing**
- **Required for certain payment terms**

Social Verification:

- **Link Facebook/LinkedIn profile**
- **Increases credibility**
- **Optional but recommended**
- **Helps with dispute resolution**

Video Verification:

- **Live video call with support team**
- **Confirm identity visually**
- **For high-value or sensitive bookings**
- **Corporate clients**

Corporate Shippers

Company Verification (Mandatory):

Step 1: Company Registration

- **Upload company registration certificate**
- **Business license**
- **Tax clearance certificate (ZIMRA)**
- **Verify with government databases**
- **Check company status (active/dissolved)**

Step 2: Directors Verification

- **CR14 form (list of directors)**
- **IDs of all directors**
- **Proof of authority to transact**
- **Board resolution (for large contracts)**

Step 3: Financial Standing

- **Bank reference letter**

- Recent financial statements (optional)
- Trade references (3 minimum)
- Credit bureau check
- Determines credit limit

Step 4: Physical Verification

- Office visit by Palmtrent team
- Confirm physical location
- Meet key personnel
- Assess legitimacy and operations
- Required for credit terms >Net 30

Step 5: Ongoing Monitoring

- Annual document renewal
- Quarterly credit reviews
- News monitoring (financial distress)
- Payment behavior tracking
- Credit limit adjustments

10.2 TRANSPORTER VERIFICATION

Document Verification

Driver Documents (Mandatory):

1. National ID / Passport:

- Valid and not expired
- Clear photo of both sides
- Biometric verification (where available)
- Cross-check with national database

2. Driver's License:

- Valid Class 2 or higher (commercial)
- Not expired

- **No major endorsements**
- **Photo matches ID**
- **Verified with VID database (where possible)**

3. Proof of Address:

- **Utility bill (within 3 months)**
- **Bank statement**
- **Rental agreement**
- **Confirms residential stability**

4. References:

- **Two contactable references**
- **Previous employers (if applicable)**
- **Long-term clients (if established driver)**
- **PalmTrent calls to verify**

Vehicle Documents (Mandatory):

1. Vehicle Registration (Blue Book):

- **Current and valid**
- **Owner name matches driver (or letter of authority)**
- **Vehicle details match (make, model, reg number)**
- **No outstanding fines or issues**

2. VID Certificate:

- **Vehicle Inspection Department certificate**
- **Must be current (within validity period)**
- **Confirms roadworthiness**
- **Required by law for commercial vehicles**

3. ZINARA License:

- **Current annual road service license**
- **All fees paid up to date**
- **Valid for vehicle class**

- **Required for legal operation**

4. Insurance Certificate:

- **Minimum: Third-party liability**
- **Current and valid (not expired)**
- **Covers commercial use**
- **Verified with insurance company**
- **Renewal tracking (platform reminds)**

5. Vehicle Photos:

- **Front, back, both sides**
- **Interior (cargo area)**
- **Any existing damage noted**
- **License plate clearly visible**
- **Updated every 6 months**

Background Checks

Criminal Record Check:

- **Police clearance certificate**
- **Checks for serious offenses:**
 - **Theft**
 - **Fraud**
 - **Violent crimes**
 - **Drug trafficking**
- **Minor offenses reviewed case-by-case**
- **Renewed annually**

Driving Record Check:

- **VID endorsement history**
- **Serious violations flagged:**
 - **DUI (disqualification)**
 - **Reckless driving (review)**

- Hit and run (disqualification)
- Multiple speeding tickets (warning)
- Points system (accumulated violations)

Social Media Check:

- Optional but recommended
- Public profile review
- Red flags:
 - Hate speech
 - Criminal boasting
 - Unprofessional conduct
- Not used for discrimination

Credit Check (For Credit Terms):

- Only for drivers seeking payment terms
- Check payment history
- Outstanding debts
- Court judgments
- Determines credit limit

Physical Vehicle Inspection

Inspection Process:

For New Drivers:

- Mandatory in-person inspection
- Conducted at Palmtrent inspection center
- Or approved third-party inspector
- Checks:
 - Vehicle condition (roadworthy)
 - Safety features (brakes, lights, tires)
 - Cargo securing equipment
 - Fire extinguisher

- **Warning triangles**
- **First aid kit**
- **Vehicle cleanliness**
- **Photos taken and uploaded**
- **Inspector signs off**
- **Valid for 6 months**

For Existing Drivers:

- **Random spot checks (10% of active drivers/month)**
- **Triggered by:**
 - **Low ratings**
 - **Complaint patterns**
 - **Long time since last check**
 - **High-value cargo bookings**
- **Re-inspection if vehicle condition concerns**

For Cross-Border Drivers:

- **Enhanced inspection (stricter standards)**
- **Additional checks:**
 - **Long-distance capability**
 - **Fuel capacity**
 - **Spare tire and tools**
 - **Communication equipment**
 - **Emergency equipment**
- **Valid for 3 months (more frequent)**

10.3 TRUST SCORES & BADGES

Trust Score System

How It Works:

Composite score (0-100) based on:

1. Verification Completeness (30%):

- **Basic verification: 10 points**
- **Enhanced verification: 10 points**
- **Background checks: 10 points**

2. Platform Activity (20%):

- **Number of completed jobs**
- **Active usage (recent logins)**
- **Response time to messages**
- **Profile completeness**

3. Performance (30%):

- **Average rating (weighted heavily)**
- **On-time delivery rate**
- **Cancellation rate (penalty)**
- **Dispute rate (penalty)**
- **Positive reviews**

4. Financial Reliability (20%):

- **Payment history (shippers)**
- **Commission payment (drivers)**
- **No outstanding disputes**
- **Insurance compliance**

Example Calculation:

Driver: Trust Ncube

Verification: 28/30 (93%)

- Basic: 10/10 

- Enhanced: 10/10 

- Background: 8/10 (minor speeding ticket)

Activity: 18/20 (90%)

- 50 completed jobs
- Active daily
- 15-min avg response time
- 100% profile complete

Performance: 27/30 (90%)

- 4.8 average rating
- 95% on-time rate
- 2% cancellation rate
- 1% dispute rate

Financial: 20/20 (100%)

- 100% payment history
- No overdue commissions
- No disputes
- Insurance current

TOTAL TRUST SCORE: 93/100 (EXCELLENT)

Trust Badges

Displayed on User Profiles:

Verified Badge ():

- Basic verification complete
- All documents approved
- Identity confirmed
- Everyone can earn

Trusted Driver ():

- 10+ completed jobs

- 4.5+ average rating
- 90%+ on-time rate
- No serious disputes
- Earns preferential matching

Premium Partner (💎):

- 100+ completed jobs
- 4.8+ average rating
- 95%+ on-time rate
- Enhanced verification complete
- Top 10% of drivers
- Special benefits and privileges

Cross-Border Certified (🌐):

- Cross-border experience (10+ trips)
- Valid passport and Yellow Card
- Clean border history
- Enhanced vehicle inspection
- Can accept international jobs

Eco-Friendly (🌱):

- Fuel-efficient vehicle
- Low emissions
- Route optimization practice
- Appeals to environmentally-conscious shippers

Safety Champion (🛡️):

- Zero accidents (12+ months)
- Advanced safety training completed
- Emergency response certified
- Preferred for high-value/sensitive cargo

Shipper Trust Levels

Bronze (New):

- 0-10 bookings
- Basic verification
- Standard platform features
- Payment before broadcast (always)

Silver (Regular):

- 11-50 bookings
- Enhanced verification
- Good payment history
- Access to volume discounts
- Can request Net 30 payment terms

Gold (Valued):

- 51+ bookings
- Excellent payment history (100% on-time)
- 4.5+ average rating
- Priority support
- Net 60 payment terms
- Exclusive deals and promotions

Platinum (VIP):

- Corporate accounts
- High volume (100+ bookings/year)
- Dedicated account manager
- Custom SLAs
- Net 90 payment terms
- API integration
- White-glove service

10.4 ONGOING MONITORING

Continuous Verification

Automated Checks:

Document Expiry Tracking:

- **System monitors all expiry dates**
- **Alerts sent 30/14/7 days before expiry:**
 - **Driver's license**
 - **VID certificate**
 - **ZINARA license**
 - **Insurance certificate**
 - **Passport (for cross-border drivers)**
- **Account restricted if expired (cannot accept new jobs)**
- **Reactivated immediately upon renewal upload**

Insurance Verification:

- **Monthly API checks with insurance partners**
- **Confirms policy still active**
- **Flags non-payment of premiums**
- **Auto-restriction if lapsed**

Criminal Record Updates:

- **Quarterly checks with law enforcement databases**
- **Alerts for new convictions**
- **Immediate review for serious offenses**
- **Account suspension pending investigation**

Performance Monitoring:

Rating Trends:

- **AI detects declining ratings**
- **Triggers review if:**
 - **Average drops below 4.0**
 - **Three consecutive ratings <3 stars**

- Sudden drop (e.g., 4.8 → 3.5)
- Platform reaches out to understand issues
- Coaching offered
- Suspension if unresolved

Complaint Patterns:

- Monitors types of complaints
- Red flags:
 - Repeated late deliveries
 - Multiple cargo damage claims
 - Unprofessional behavior reports
 - Payment collection issues
- Progressive warnings
- Mandatory retraining
- Suspension for serious/repeated issues

Behavioral Red Flags:

- GPS manipulation attempts
- Excessive route deviations
- Speed violations (patterns)
- Communication blackouts
- Suspicious payment patterns
- Investigated and addressed promptly

Quality Assurance

Random Audits:

- 5-10% of completed jobs audited monthly
- Verification steps:
 - Call shipper (was service satisfactory?)
 - Call driver (any issues?)
 - Review GPS data (route reasonable?)

- **Check photos (quality and authenticity)**
 - **Verify timing (pickup/delivery accurate?)**
- **Findings inform improvements**
- **Fraud detection**

Mystery Shopper Program:

- **Palmtrent staff book transport (incognito)**
- **Experience platform as real users**
- **Assess driver professionalism**
- **Check cargo handling**
- **Verify platform processes**
- **Identify pain points**
- **Reward excellent service**
- **Address poor performance**

Customer Feedback Analysis:

- **Weekly review of all feedback**
- **Sentiment analysis (AI-powered)**
- **Identify common themes**
- **Action items created**
- **Follow-up with users**

Continuous improvement cycle